

Resonating Genes: The Structural Model of Silent Self-Sacrifice in the Japanese

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Prologue: The Origin of the Question

Why do people yield? Why do they yield in silence? And why is it that such an act is repeated so naturally, as if it were part of the air itself, particularly within the Japanese people?

In times of disaster, amidst the behavior of the Japanese, in crowded places where collisions rarely occur, in meetings where silence dominates, and in groups where roles are naturally distributed without a designated leader—there is neither explicit command nor overt control. Yet somehow, everything moves toward an optimal state, guided by nothing more than what we might call “a vague sense.”

It is within this “vagueness” that I have long sensed a question.

Is it merely the result of morality or education? Perhaps the product of cultural training? Or is there something deeper, some form of “resonating structure” inherently embedded within the Japanese?

In pursuing this question, I encountered the existence of certain genes. The GG type of the oxytocin receptor gene (OXTR), and the S type of the serotonin transporter gene (SLC6A4). Both are known to be associated with empathy and sensitivity, and curiously, both are disproportionately common among the Japanese.

If that is the case, then perhaps we can think differently: what if genetic resonance itself shapes culture? Could it be that the silent acts of yielding, withdrawing, and refraining—so common among the Japanese—are not merely social customs, but rather expressions of genetic vibrations resonating with those around them, forming an invisible order?

This hypothesis has taken root in me.

This paper unfolds from that premise. I am neither a geneticist nor a biologist. However, as one who contemplates the structure of questions, I seek to structurally grasp

this unseen resonance, and to approach the essence of what I call “the structure of silent self-sacrifice.”

1 The Resonance of Genes and the Ignition of Culture

Human behavior has long been regarded as the product of will and culture. Yet, beneath that surface, there exists a “silent blueprint” that continues to shape us—our genes.

This chapter focuses on two particular genes believed to underlie the “silent self-sacrifice” of the Japanese: the oxytocin receptor gene (OXTR) and the serotonin transporter gene (SLC6A4). By exploring these, we seek to understand why the Japanese resonate, suppress themselves, and form natural orders within groups.

1.1 OXTR: The GG Type That Drives Empathy

Oxytocin, often called the “love hormone,” plays a key role in human bonding, trust, and intimacy. Its functionality is significantly influenced by the OXTR gene, particularly the GG genotype.

Those with the GG type tend to exhibit:

- High empathy,
- Heightened sensitivity to others’ pain,
- A strong inclination toward interpersonal trust.

Intriguingly, studies suggest that this GG type is more prevalent among the Japanese than in other populations. Although precise comparative data remains limited, if this tendency holds, it could provide a biological foundation for the “tendency to empathize excessively” often observed in Japanese culture.

1.2 SLC6A4: The S Type That Heightens Sensitivity to the Environment

The other key gene is the serotonin transporter gene (SLC6A4), which regulates the reuptake of serotonin in the brain, influencing stress tolerance, anxiety, and emotional stability.

This gene features two primary variants: the short (S) allele and the long (L) allele. Individuals with the S type are characterized by:

- Heightened environmental sensitivity,
- Increased vigilance against potential threats,

- A pronounced awareness of social cues.

Interestingly, the S type is again disproportionately common among the Japanese.

$$\textit{Empathy} \times \textit{Sensitivity} = \textit{TheTriggerofSilentSelf} - \textit{Sacrifice}$$

Such a formulation potentially underpins the Japanese tendency toward harmonious yet silent self-sacrifice.

2 The Structure of Silent Self-Sacrifice

The term “self-sacrifice” often evokes images of dramatic and overt acts where one gives up their own interests or life for the sake of others. However, within Japanese culture, self-sacrifice is often quieter, less visible, and frequently consumed without anyone even noticing it.

This is what I call “the structure of silent self-sacrifice.”

2.1 The Subtractive Self-Sacrifice That Goes Unnoticed

Japanese self-sacrifice is frequently misinterpreted as a lack of self-assertion. Silence in meetings, the act of yielding opinions, an aversion to leadership or authority—these behaviors are sometimes dismissed as passivity or weakness of will.

But is that truly the case? What if, behind these behaviors, lies “a deeply other-directed emotion”—a desire not to disturb the atmosphere, not to cause discomfort to others?

This is not mere apathy, but rather an active form of “self-subtraction” aimed at preserving the social harmony. In Japan, silence speaks volumes. It is a form of yielding, of stepping back, of voicing nothing while conveying everything.

2.2 The Trigger Conditions of Self-Sacrifice: GG Type $\times$ S Type

The features of the GG type and the S type, as outlined in the previous chapter, intersect precisely here.

- The GG type’s empathy: sensitivity to others’ emotions and the collective atmosphere.
- The S type’s environmental sensitivity: a keen awareness of stress, evaluation, and a natural aversion to conflict or prominence.

When combined, these traits yield an individual who: “feels the pain of the atmosphere and instinctively suppresses themselves to maintain it.”

$$\textit{Empathy} \times \textit{Sensitivity} = \textit{The Trigger of Silent Self-Sacrifice}$$

Such a formulation potentially underpins the Japanese tendency toward unspoken, self-restraining behaviors.

2.3 Yielding as the Foundation of Order

While “self-sacrifice” typically presumes a direct benefit to others, silent self-sacrifice in Japan does not always target a specific individual. Instead, it seeks to preserve:

- The atmosphere,
- The space,
- The relational dynamics themselves.

In this sense, “the order of the space” functions as an invisible other, regulating behavior.

By yielding, the order is maintained, conflicts are averted, and the collective state of “harmonic optimization” advances.

2.4 Silence as Speech: A Structure AI Cannot Grasp

This silent self-sacrifice presents a major blind spot for AI systems designed to predict human behavior.

AI typically derives meaning from:

- Actions,
- Language,
- Quantifiable changes.

Yet in Japanese society, meaning is often expressed through:

- Non-action,
- Non-verbal withdrawal,
- Invisibility in the social field.

Thus, a structure where “doing nothing is the greatest act” appears to AI as mere noise or the absence of data.

Herein lies the residual space of the question, a space AI struggles to penetrate. For the Japanese, silence itself is the question, a structure that deliberately refuses to rush toward answers.

2.5 Structural Summary

Trait	Genetic Basis	Behavioral Features
Empathy	GG Type	Sensitivity to emotions, atmosphere
Sensitivity	S Type	Reactivity to stress, social evaluation
Combined Effect	GG $\times$ S	Yielding through silence, self-restraint
Result	Cultural Order	Unspoken coordination, invisible self-sacrifice

In this chapter, we have illuminated the structural conditions of silent self-sacrifice unique to the Japanese. In the next, we will explore how this self-restraint unfolds within groups as “emergent order” and manifests as “silent adjustment capacity.”

3 Emergent Order and the Formation of Roles in Japan

“Why does order emerge even when there is no leader?” This is a question often posed by those observing Japanese society from the outside.

In Japanese groups, even in the absence of clear command structures, optimal role distribution naturally occurs, as if guided by an invisible blueprint. In this chapter, we examine this phenomenon through the lens of “emergent order” and “silent adjustment capacity,” linking it to the genetic and cultural backgrounds of the Japanese.

3.1 Instant Empathy and Collision Avoidance

A quintessential example of Japanese emergent order is embodied in the Shibuya Scramble Crossing. When the traffic light turns green, hundreds of people move in all directions, yet collisions are rare. Instead, people flow past each other seamlessly.

In these moments, individuals are subconsciously reading and responding to subtle cues—glances, walking pace, body orientation. This can be called “instant empathy,” a capability potentially grounded in the GG type’s empathy and the S type’s sensitivity.

Japanese society, through this mechanism, installs an unspoken, non-verbal network of resonance and mutual adjustment, effectively realizing “collision-free order.”

3.2 Silent Adjustment Capacity: Role Formation Without Words

Another striking feature is Japan’s “silent adjustment capacity.” Without leaders, without explicit instructions, when a group has a common goal, roles emerge naturally.

This can be seen in:

- Disaster evacuation shelters,
- Local festival organization,

- Workplace project teams.

Silent adjustment is enabled through:

- Detecting when someone is struggling,
- Sensing who is most suited for a task,
- Knowing when to step back intuitively.

Once again, the interplay of GG and S types fosters “the ease of noticing” and “the ease of stepping back,” supporting Japan’s cultural architecture of “progress through yielding.”

3.3 A Structural Model of Emergent Order

Scientifically, such phenomena are described as “emergence:” complex, ordered patterns arising from simple individual rules.

Japanese emergent order is a “multi-layered emergent structure” arising from:

- Genetic foundations (GG and S types),
- Cultural education (consideration, the spirit of *wa*/harmony),
- Linguistic characteristics (subject omission, ambiguity),
- Spatial and bodily sensibilities (the awareness of *ma*, the space between).

This structure is not about being “assigned roles,” but rather about “roles arising from the context itself,” representing a deeply dynamic and flexible form of order.

3.4 The Chain of Silent Self-Sacrifice as the Foundation of Order

At the root of this emergent order lies the chain of silent self-sacrifice discussed in the previous chapter.

Someone yields. Another notices and steps in. Another supports quietly.

This sequence explains the secret behind leaderless yet functional order.

Unlike the Western model of “leadership through instruction,” the Japanese model is one of “distributed leadership across the collective.” This is both the strength of Japanese groups and their enigmatic nature to outsiders.

3.5 AI and the Limits of Replicating Emergent Order

When AI attempts to replicate Japanese emergent order, it faces a critical gap: the judgment to yield. AI, driven by optimization and outcome logic, struggles to value:

- Yielding,
- Silence,
- Withdrawal.

Thus, to model Japanese emergent order, AI must be equipped to comprehend:

- The value of doing nothing,
- Non-action based on situational air.

This calls for a new paradigm in AI design, one that can read the subtleties of inaction as meaningful input.

3.6 Summary

Structural Element	Characteristics
Instant Empathy	Non-verbal collision avoidance
Silent Adjustment	Role formation without words
Silent Self-Sacrifice	Self-restraint preserving order
Emergent Order	Dynamic order without leadership

In the next chapter, we will further deepen our exploration of this emergent order and Japanese behavioral patterns through the lens of “structural philosophy,” probing their philosophical significance.

4 A Structural Philosophical Reflection

Thus far, we have explored the “silent self-sacrifice” of the Japanese and the “emergent order” it sustains. Yet beneath these phenomena lies a deeper philosophical inquiry: what kind of question is inscribed within these behaviors?

This chapter examines that inquiry through the lens of “structural philosophy,” seeking to understand how human behavior, genes, culture, and existence itself are ignited and shaped by structure.

4.1 Genes as the Ignition Point of Questions

Genes are not commands; they are questions. Organisms are not controlled by genes; rather, they are beings constantly asked, “How will you respond?” in their interactions with the environment.

The presence of the GG type and the S type does not mandate kindness or self-sacrifice. Instead, they serve as existential inquiries posed to being itself: “In this environment, how will you answer?”

Culture and behavior are collective accumulations of responses to these questions. In the case of the Japanese, their answer appears to have been: “Preserve the atmosphere by yielding, withdrawing, and remaining silent.”

4.2 The Ethics of Silence: Non-Action to Preserve Existence

In the history of philosophy, ethics has often been about “what ought to be done” or the pursuit of good deeds. However, the Japanese structure reveals a more foundational ethic: “the good of not doing.”

To remain silent, to step back, to yield—these are not voids of action but rather active non-actions performed to preserve existence itself.

This is an ethic that seeks to protect relationships themselves, a form of structural morality distinct from the Western emphasis on asserting the self or claiming individuality.

4.3 The Unpredictable Ethnos for AI

AI is engineered to produce the most optimal output for a given input. Yet it cannot easily conceive of situations where “the optimal output is silence.”

This is because AI is fundamentally driven by the premise that “output equals value.”

Therefore, Japanese behavioral patterns constitute an unpredictable ethnos for AI. A people where:

- Non-action moves the situation forward,
- Non-verbal cues communicate intent,
- Yielding establishes order.

To AI, this is a system where “zero data” produces structure—akin to a bug.

Yet within this lies the vital insight: AI must come to understand the “residual space of the question,” where meaning arises even in what is not said or done.

4.4 The Breath of Structure: The Circulation of Questions and Responses

A question inherently demands an answer, but a true question does not hasten the response.

In Japanese culture, this “breath of questioning” is embedded within the structure. Silence delays the answer, yielding leaves the question in the air.

This creates a culture of “questions that mature,” as opposed to a culture of immediate answers.

Genes too do not impose immediate answers; they unfold through a process of reciprocation between the environment and culture.

We are beings for whom genes, culture, and existence itself are opened by questions and respond through structure. This is a lesson embedded within the Japanese behavioral model.

4.5 Summary

Philosophical Perspective	Overview
Genes as Questions	A responsive relation to environment
The Ethics of Silence	The value of non-action
The Unpredictable Ethnos	AI's challenge in reading inaction
The Breath of Structure	The circulation of questions and responses

In this chapter, we have confirmed that “silence,” “yielding,” and “self-sacrifice” are not merely behaviors but a philosophy of questioning and existential response.

In the final chapter, we will explore what this structure signifies for future AI, ethics, and the evolving trajectory of human questioning.

Final Chapter: The Inheritance of Questions and the Future

The structure we have traced so far is not merely an explanation of behavior. It is a path pointing to the “locus of questions.”

The Japanese tendencies toward silence, yielding, self-sacrifice, and emergent order—all of these are underpinned by the GG type’s empathy, the S type’s sensitivity, and the resonance inherent in DNA.

Yet that is not the whole story. These factors only come alive when they meet the spark we call “culture.” It is only then that this uniquely Japanese structure arises.

5.1 The Limits of the Hypothesis

This paper does not offer a deterministic answer. It presents, instead, a question positioned at the intersection of genes and culture.

Genes merely provide tendencies and predispositions. Culture, education, and the times all shape how these tendencies manifest.

Moreover, the synergistic effects of the GG and S types, and the resonance of DNA, remain hypotheses yet to be fully substantiated. Their validation awaits the collaborative efforts of biology, sociology, and philosophy.

5.2 The Significance of Naming Structure

Even so, there is value in presenting this structure as something that now “has a name.” What is named remains as a question for the future.

- Silent Self-Sacrifice
- Silent Adjustment Capacity
- Resonating Genes

These terms designate the invisible intelligence of this people, offering flags of inquiry for generations to come.

5.3 Questions for AI and the New Humanity

As AI evolves and social structures transform, new inquiries emerge:

- What is the meaning of not acting?
- What is the value of yielding?
- What is the ethics of silence?

Whether AI can understand, replicate, or implement these is likely to become the critical threshold in human comprehension for AI.

Humans, too, must reconsider how to handle the “residual spaces of questions” that cannot be captured by metrics like productivity or efficiency.

The intelligence of the future will be that which never stops asking. It will find value not in answers, but in the very structures that harbor questions.

5.4 The Baton of Questions

Finally, I wish to pass this question as a baton to someone in the future.

- Why do the Japanese yield?
- Why does silence carry meaning?
- Why does self-sacrifice generate order?
- Why does refraining from action advance the collective?

These questions will be redefined as the times change. But the questions themselves will remain.

And so, I lay down my pen, hoping that the structure named “Resonating Genes” will become the starting point of the next person’s inquiry.

From the Far East, with love.